Emotions and feelings

The same brown can evoke **home** in one of us and **heaviness** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Safety

A feeling that you **can lean back** and need not keep watch over your surroundings all the time.

And why?

Brown is the colour of soil, wood and bread, that is, of things that hold. After a period of change you may enjoy something familiar, tangible and simple. A surrounding where you do not have to be ready to react all the time.

Ask yourself

"What gives me firm ground under my feet today?"

Comfort

A feeling of **a soft jumper**, a warm drink and a chair you do not want to leave.

And why?

Comfort is a real need, not a sin. Brown materials, wool, wood and ceramics offer it directly. Just ask whether comfort serves you, or already holds you in place.

And what if I asked you now?

"What does my body good today?"

Sensuality

A craving for chocolate, satin and **a depth of touch** that does not need to shout.

And why?

Chocolate satin, caramel skin and chestnut hair carry warmth without a big announcement. Sensuality need not arrive in a red sports car. Sometimes it comes quietly and is certainly not boring.

And try answering now

"Where in my body do I feel at home?"

Aversion

A feeling that you **must not like** the colour, or that it simply reminds you of something you don't want on your shoe.

And why?

Brown does not recall only coffee and wood. It can also recall mud, dirt or something spoiled. You need not look behind the aversion for a rejection of roots. Sometimes it is just the picture the colour brings.

And now one question for you

"What actually bothers me, the colour, or what it reminds me of?"

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Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

Home base

A feeling that you **belong somewhere**, even when a lot is changing around you.

And why?

A home base need not be large. It is an ordinary table, regular meals, a safe home or a person in front of whom you do not have to perform. Brown can remind you of what supports you even when nobody admires it.

Ask yourself

"What really supports and nourishes me in everyday life?"

Stiffness

A feeling that **nothing has changed here for a long time**, and it all somehow holds comfortably.

And why?

Brown can say "it is good here", but sometimes you hear in it "nothing has changed here for a long time". Old furniture, little light or a surrounding where new ideas were hardly welcome add to this. What one woman lives as certainty, another lives as immobility.

And what if I asked you now?

"Am I well in this constancy, or do I already need to set something moving?"

A worry that just keeps returning

Thoughts that **go round and round** and move nowhere.

And why?

In the five-element tradition worry and rumination belong, among other things, to earth. An activity with a concrete material can help. Repotting a plant, kneading dough or spreading paint. The hands attend to something with shape and resistance and the head rests for a moment.

And try answering now

"What could pull me out of my head into my hands right now?"

Homesickness

A scent, a fabric or wood and **suddenly you are somewhere else**.

And why?

Colours attach to specific places. Brown can bring back grandma's kitchen or a room where you did not feel at home. Longing or relief shows everything you carry with the colour.

And now one question for you

"What would I give my younger self today?"

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My brown is not the same as your brown

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **Wooden table**
  For one family dinners, for another an inheritance she did not want.
- **Brown jumper**
  For one comfort and warmth, for another the role of the good and inconspicuous one.
- **Chocolate**
  For one a reward, for another a memory of a ban.
- **Brown bathroom**
  For one the past, for another simply bad taste.
- **Chestnut hair**
  For one a frame for the face, for another a colour she did not want.

Why does it attract me right now?

Perhaps you needed nothing for a long time and suddenly something solid is missing. You need not look for a message in that. You change blonde to chestnut and your own face surprises you in the mirror. As if it had gained a warmer tone and the eyes stood out more. **You did not get new skin, you changed the colour surroundings of the face.** Honey blonde can look warm and ash brown cool, depending on the specific shades.

Why can't I stand it?

Perhaps you see in it old flats, school desks or a surrounding where nothing could be tried. Then perhaps you are not rejecting the colour. **You are rejecting the life you link with it.** Try imagining side by side brown plastic furniture, a glossy chestnut and a soft jumper. The same colour family, quite different company.

When to keep it and when to take some away

Keep it when you feel good beside it and do not have to talk yourself into a pleasant impression. Take away when the whole seems heavy, blurring or foreign. First try one change. Lighter textiles, fewer things, a bit of greenery. **Grandma's armchair can stay, the whole way of life need not stay with it.**

Ask yourself

“Which sentence about brown is loudest in me? Whose is it, actually?”

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